01 DECEMBER

Right in the Middle of Moving In

On the first of December, a tiny suitcase stood in front of the little elf door.
Beside it lay a sock, a cup, and a cushion.
But there was no sign of the elf.
Suddenly, the suitcase started to wobble. "Don't close it!"
The lid popped open, and the elf appeared between a scarf and a nightcap. "I'm still in here!"
He climbed out and looked around. Apparently, while unpacking, he had climbed back into his suitcase.
"I was looking for something."
The elf leaned inside. First he pulled out a brush, then two socks and a spoon.
"No. No. Not that either."
Finally, he disappeared almost completely into the suitcase. Only his feet were sticking out. A moment later, he came back up, triumphantly holding a little key.
"Found it!"
He put it into the lock of his elf door and turned it. Nothing happened.
The elf tried again and looked at the key.
"Hmm."
He went over to the suitcase and put the key into its lock.
Click. The suitcase snapped shut.
The elf stared at it. "Oh."
Then he looked at his little door and grinned.
"Fine. Apparently, I can move in without a key."

